J. LAWTON COLLINS
TOP 3 LEGENDARY TACTICAL MOVES

Publishing guide: everything you need to upload the finished video



Main thumbnail: THE GAMBLE (made with vidIQ: dark battlefield + a generic US major general in colour, not a likeness)

1. The finished video

Item	Details
File	Collins-Top3-1080p.mp4 (1920x1080, 30 fps, H.264 + AAC, 683 MB)
Download	https://gofile.io/d/ZldBI7vf
Length	13:29
Voice	Voice A: Kokoro am_michael converted to the owner's voice (reference: the approved voice-A sample, see note in chat)
Music	Kevin MacLeod, 4 tracks, CC BY 4.0, ducked under the voice (locked level 0.08)
Sound effects	The channel's locked kit: Freesound recordings (CC BY / CC0), Mixkit sounds, original effects

Chapters

Starts	Chapter
0:00	Intro: The Bombs That Fell Short
1:06	Lightning Joe and the Road to Utah Beach
2:00	Move 1: Cutting Off Cherbourg (June 1944)
3:38	The Assault on the Fortress
4:36	Schlieben Surrenders
5:57	Move 2: Operation Cobra (July 1944)
7:45	Four Thousand Tons
8:32	The Gamble: Committing the Armour
9:17	Out of the Hedgerows to Avranches
9:43	Move 3: Celles, Battle of the Bulge (December 1944)
10:45	Fall Back or Attack?
11:36	Christmas Morning: In the Bag
12:45	Legacy

Key frames (hook 0:01-0:47, carpet bombing 7:50, Celles 11:30)


25 JULY 1944
ALLIES
GERMAN
1,170
HEAVY BOMBERS
25 JULY 1944 · HEAVY BOMBERS ALONE · NORMANDY
USA
BRITAIN
GERMANY
25 JULY 1944
ALLIES
GERMAN
SAINT-LÔ
COUTANCES
31 JULY 1944
ALLIES
GERMAN
USA
BAYEUX
SAINT-LÔ
COUTANCES
GERMANY
GRANVILLE
VIRE
1 AUGUST 1944
ALLIES
GERMAN
GEORGE S. PATTON
US THIRD ARMY
USA
GERMANY
AVRANCHES · 31 JULY
1 AUGUST 1944
ALLIES
GERMAN
GEORGE S. PATTON
US THIRD ARMY
USA
GERMANY
?
INTO BRITTANY
AVRANCHES · 31 JULY
INTO FRANCE
ALLIES
GERMANY
NEUTRAL
J. LAWTON COLLINS
MAJOR GENERAL · US VII CORPS
BRITAIN
GERMANY
SWITZERLAND
25 JULY 1944
AMERICAN
GERMAN
25 JULY 1944 · THE CARPET
1,500+ HEAVY BOMBERS
3,250 TONS OF BOMBS
GERMANY
SAINT-LÔ
MARIGNY
24 DECEMBER · EVENING
ALLIES
GERMAN
CHRISTMAS EVE
OPTION 1
FALL BACK
OPTION 2
ATTACK
FALL-BACK LINE
USA
BRITAIN
DINANT
CIREY
2ND ARMD (CCB)
GELLES
2ND ARMD (CCA)
HOTTON
3RD ARMD
MANHAY
84TH
BASTOGNE
ROCHEFORT
COLLINS
WEIGHS IT UP
GERMANY

2. Title and thumbnail

Title (locked, vidIQ score 91)

J. Lawton Collins's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The Man Who Broke Open Normandy

Alternatives (vidIQ scores):

- J. Lawton Collins's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The General Who Did What Patton Got Credit For (96; good A/B title)
- Lightning Joe Collins's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The Man Who Broke Hitler's Normandy Front (92)

Why this thumbnail

Tactical Genius picture formula: a dark, desaturated aerial battlefield with red/blue unit blocks and white arrows on the left, the commander in COLOUR on the right (owner 2026-10-30: only the general is in colour), a red brush banner bottom-left. **THE GAMBLE** is type 1 (his decision): committing the armour before the breach was secure, the move that broke open Normandy (title promise), shown over the Cobra carpet bombing of the hook.

Alternative for YouTube's Test & compare: **4,000 TONS** (type 3, ominous stakes: the carpet bombing of 25 July).



Checked: the only text is the banner (spelling correct). Hedgerow fields, the straight road and four-engine heavy bombers match Normandy, 25 July 1944. The portrait is an AI-generated generic US Army major general of 1944 (bareheaded, two stars on the collar, correct rank for Collins in 1944); it is not presented as a photo or likeness of Collins.

Before uploading: check the thumbnail at small size on a phone.

3. Description (copy and paste)

The first line is the title. Everything after it is the description: ready to paste, with NO links (channel rule). Keep the credit lines: the music, sound, archive and image licences require them.

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J. Lawton Collins's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The Man Who Broke Open Normandy

Fifteen hundred heavy bombers. More than three thousand tons of bombs on a strip of Normandy barely
three and a half miles wide, and some of them fell on American soldiers. Within a week the German
front in Normandy had been torn open, and the man who broke it was not Patton.

J. Lawton "Lightning Joe" Collins commanded the US VII Corps from Utah Beach to the Elbe. In this
video we break down his three greatest tactical moves: cutting off and storming the fortress port
of Cherbourg in June 1944, throwing his armour into the chaos of Operation Cobra to break out of
Normandy in July 1944, and destroying the spearhead of the 2nd Panzer Division at Celles, just
short of the Meuse, on Christmas Day 1944.

Cut them off, then never let them dig in. Throw the tanks into the chaos. Hit the spearhead when it
runs dry.

Which commander should we cover next? Let us know in the comments.

CHAPTERS
0:00 Intro: The Bombs That Fell Short
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SOURCES
Gordon A. Harrison, Cross-Channel Attack (US Army in World War II, Center of Military History)
Utah Beach to Cherbourg, 6-27 June 1944 (American Forces in Action series, Historical Division, War
Department)
Martin Blumenson, Breakout and Pursuit (US Army in World War II, Center of Military History)
Hugh M. Cole, The Ardennes: Battle of the Bulge (US Army in World War II, Center of Military
History)
HistoryNet, "Ernie Harmon: The Other Patton"

CREDITS
Maps: original animations. Terrain: Mapzen / AWS Terrain Tiles (open data). Map data ©
OpenStreetMap contributors (ODbL). Rivers and lakes on the overview map: Natural Earth (public
domain). Historical borders: aourednik/historical-basemaps.

Music by Kevin MacLeod (incompetech.com): "Long Note One", "Wounded", "Long Note Two", "Anguish".
Licensed under Creative Commons: By Attribution 4.0.

Sound effects: "artillery distance" by 2887679652 (CC BY 4.0), "Cannon Artillery distant gunshots"
by Aegersum (CC BY 3.0), "Distant explosion" by juskiddink (CC BY 4.0), "Distant explosions" by
Kostrava (CC0), via freesound.org. Aircraft and transition sounds: Mixkit (Mixkit Sound Effects
Free License). Other sound effects: original.

Images:
- Bundesarchiv, Bild 146-1978-033-02, photographer: Dinstühler, CC BY-SA 3.0 DE (Fritz Bayerlein)
- Public domain: US Army / Signal Corps / National Archives photographs of J. Lawton Collins, Omar
Bradley, George S. Patton, Lesley McNair, Ernest Harmon, Isaac D. White, Bernard Montgomery and the
surrender of Karl-Wilhelm von Schlieben; national flags.
Archive film: US Army Signal Corps, US Navy and United News/OWI newsreel footage via the US
National Archives (public domain).

Narration voice: AI-generated. Maps: original animations.
■ Business enquiries: [email to fill in]

#LawtonCollins #OperationCobra #MilitaryHistory
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4. Upload settings

Setting	Value
Tags	military history, ww2 documentary, western front, J. Lawton Collins, Lightning Joe Collins, VII Corps, Operation Cobra, Battle of Cherbourg, Battle of the Bulge, Battle of Celles, Normandy breakout, Fritz Bayerlein, Panzer Lehr, Omar Bradley, George Patton, animated battle map, greatest military tactics, ww2 animated history
Category	Education
Audience	Not made for kids
Language / captions	English; let YouTube auto-caption, then check the names (Collins, Schlieben, Cotentin, Barneville, Fort du Roule, Bayerlein, Panzer Lehr, Marigny, Coutances, Avranches, McNair, Celles, Foy-Notre-Dame, Dinant, Harmon)
Altered or synthetic content	Yes: the narration is an AI voice and the thumbnail battlefield is AI-generated. Tick the disclosure box.
Chapters	Automatic from the description (first chapter is 0:00)
Pinned comment	Which commander should we cover next? Ridgway, Bradley, Hodges, Harmon...?
Schedule	Your audience's peak time (YouTube Studio > Analytics > Audience)

Upload checklist

- Play the 1080p master through once (sound, sync, no black frames).
- Upload the master.
- Paste title, description and tags; upload the thumbnail (1280x720).
- Fill in the business email in the description.
- Tick 'altered or synthetic content'.
- Add end screen and cards; set visibility and schedule.
- After 24-48 h: check click-through rate and 30-second retention; if CTR is under 2% after ~1,000 impressions, switch to the alternative thumbnail.

Facts to double-check before publishing (approximate, single-source or from memory; see research/FACT_NOTES*.md):
• Collins as Army Chief of Staff 1949-53 (archive caption); the origin of the nickname Lightning Joe.
• Cobra target box ~6,000 x 2,200 yards (said and shown as about 3.5 miles wide).
• Celles losses: Cole's figures for the whole 2nd Armored operation 24-27 Dec (HistoryNet gives a wider range).
• 'Deepest point' of the German offensive (standard wording).
• Kelly and Ogden units; MacKelvie relieved ~13 June; Culin's hedgerow cutters (from memory, standard facts).
• Harmon's 'the bastards are in the bag' is attributed via HistoryNet and said as 'reportedly'.
• All front lines are approximate (logged per date in research/FACT_NOTES_*.md), esp. Cobra 27 July and the Bulge's south edge on 24 Dec.